BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

When checks happen

Relative milestones, not equal time intervals. Your team books tests and reviews results; this map does not confirm completion.

Check	Before starting	First treatment	During treatment	Change / completion	Follow-up
Blood / organ function	FBC, renal, liver baseline	Review results before dose	FBC / renal / liver every cycle; Day 8 FBC	Confirm counts for each planned dose	Investigate persisting problems
Heart / nerves	Cardiac function if history / prior anthracycline	Neuropathy and symptom review	Cardiac review when clinically indicated	Review neuropathy before next dose	Report persistent symptoms

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00736 v2 · official regimen · NICE NG101 · bone health and follow-up · ASCO · biomarkers in metastatic breast cancer · ESMO metastatic breast cancer guideline · 2026

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Nab-paclitaxel · Days 1, 8 and 15 of 28: treatment and checks

Metastatic breast cancer after anthracycline failure or when unsuitable, with standard paclitaxel unsuitable

Nab-paclitaxel on Days 1, 8 and 15 of each 28-day cycle, with a planned week off on Day 22. Continue while beneficial and tolerated. This off-label schedule requires specific consent.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	First treatment	During treatment	Change / completion	Follow-up
Treatment plan NCCP 00736	Confirm off-label rationale	Days 1 / 8 / 15 infusions	Day 22 treatment-free; repeat q28	Until progression / intolerance	Next treatment plan
Blood / organ function NCCP 00736	FBC, renal, liver baseline	Review results before dose	FBC / renal / liver every cycle; Day 8 FBC	Confirm counts for each planned dose	Investigate persisting problems
Heart / nerves NCCP 00736	Cardiac function if history / prior anthracycline	Neuropathy and symptom review	Cardiac review when clinically indicated	Review neuropathy before next dose	Report persistent symptoms
Cancer review METASTATIC · MARKERS	Confirm setting	Agree review plan	Response / symptom review	Next treatment / completion	Agreed surveillance

What each check is for

1 Before treatment

Before the first dose

Metastatic breast cancer after anthracycline failure or when unsuitable, with standard paclitaxel unsuitable. FBC, kidney and liver tests at baseline and before each cycle; NCCP explicitly lists a Day 8 FBC. The unit confirms count testing for every administration decision, including Day 15.

Ask / act: Confirm eligibility, test results and medicine list.

Sources: NCCP 00736

2 Other checks

At the specified review points

Baseline cardiac assessment for significant cardiac history or prior anthracyclines; ongoing tests as indicated. Review neuropathy and the separate Day 1/later-day dose rules.

Ask / act: Confirm who arranges and reviews each check.

Sources: NCCP 00736

3 Support and practical plan

At each treatment or phase change

Routine allergy premedicines are usually not required for nab-paclitaxel. Prior reactions require individual review; treatment is still given where a serious reaction can be managed.

Ask / act: Choose the matching support plan; confirm active medicines.

Sources: NCCP 00736

4 Response and follow-up

Agreed review points

Agree the scan type and review interval for the known disease sites. Review response, symptoms and toxicity together; new or worsening symptoms may need an earlier assessment. Keep the agreed follow-up and report persistent or new symptoms between visits.

Ask / act: Review symptoms, results and patient priorities.

Sources: METASTATIC · MARKERS

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-10-25 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.19